

**Topic A2:
Revolution,
Republic and
Restoration:
England, 1629-67**

17th century, and the extent of its recovery by 1667. The key issues arising include the reasons for the collapse of royal authority in the 1640s, the role of key individuals such as Charles I and Cromwell, the difficulties of replacing the monarchy with a settled government, and the nature of what was 'restored' in the 1660s. The key areas of study required for part A are summarised in the four content bullet points and the two associated controversies to be examined in part B are clearly delimited underneath in the unit content section of the specification. Collectively, they offer a framework for understanding the period as a whole.

Although the bullet points are defined and clarified separately here, students should appreciate the links between them, since questions may be set which target the content of more than one bullet point. For example, judgements about what was restored in 1660-62 and the extent to which the monarch regained his power will, if effective comparisons are to be made, draw on knowledge related to the first bullet point as well as the fourth.

The first bullet point relates to the actions and policies of Charles I in the 1630s and to the roles played by his key advisers. Students should have detailed knowledge of events and policies in England and of the main features of Charles's rule in Ireland and Scotland in this period. They should also have some understanding of the problems that Charles inherited, in order to assess his role and contribution to the crisis, but they are not required to have knowledge of events before 1629. Students should also understand the nature of opposition during the 1630s and have knowledge of the key events that contributed to it.

The second bullet point encompasses the process by which war broke out in 1640-42, the strengths and weaknesses of both sides, the initial advantages held by the Royalists and the gradual development of Parliamentary superiority. Students should understand the reasons for Parliament's victory in 1646, including the role of key individuals such as Pym, Fairfax and Cromwell, the Royalist generals and the king himself. Students should understand the wider context of war across three kingdoms but are not required to have detailed knowledge of events in Scotland and Ireland.

The third bullet point relates to the search for settled government. This should include both the efforts to find a settlement with the king to 1649 and the attempts to find one without him in 1649-53. Students should have detailed knowledge of the various proposals made and the constitutional experiments of 1649-53, including both the rule of the Rump and of the 'Barebones' Parliament. They should understand the reasons for failure the role of the king himself, of the army leaders, the radicals and the republican faction, and the importance of religious issues as well as political aims. They should be aware of how and why the Protectorate was established.

The final bullet point encompasses the growing desire for stability and students should be aware of the monarchical features of the later Protectorate. They should have detailed knowledge of Richard Cromwell's problems and the collapse of the Protectorate in 1659, the reasons for the failure of the Rump, and the events leading up to the return of Charles II. To make assessments as to what was restored, they should have sufficient knowledge of the Restoration settlement, the powers exercised by the king and by parliaments, in practice as well as theoretically, and of the application of the settlement until 1667.

In section B, students will use their knowledge of the period as a whole to provide a broad context, but, in addition, they will need detailed knowledge of the two issues selected as subjects of historical controversy and an understanding of why they have been the subject of debate.

The first controversy requires specific knowledge of the patterns of allegiance developed in 1640-43 and the ability to relate these to the wider issues and causes of crisis in order to assess what determined 'side taking' and to understand why the issue remains controversial. They should be aware of the different attempts to explain the causes of the war, the varying emphasis placed by historians on religious, constitutional, economic and individual circumstances, the contradictory nature of the available evidence, and the difficulties of relating wider issues to personal motivation.

The second controversy requires detailed knowledge of the aims and factions that influenced the emergence and development of the Protectorate in 1654-8, the role of Oliver Cromwell, the conflicting aims of radical/conservative and military/civilian groups, and the difficulty of reconciling their interests. Again, an understanding of why the Protectorate enjoyed only limited success and why the issue has caused debate and controversy needs to be grounded in an overall understanding of the period and the ways in which it has been studied.